



Your Word Is Your Wand

Visual Concept Atlas — Audio Companion

A guided walk through the sixteen images of the atlas. For each one, what you are seeing, the idea it holds, and how to use it. Listen straight through, or stop at whichever image you need today.

The Word as a Wand



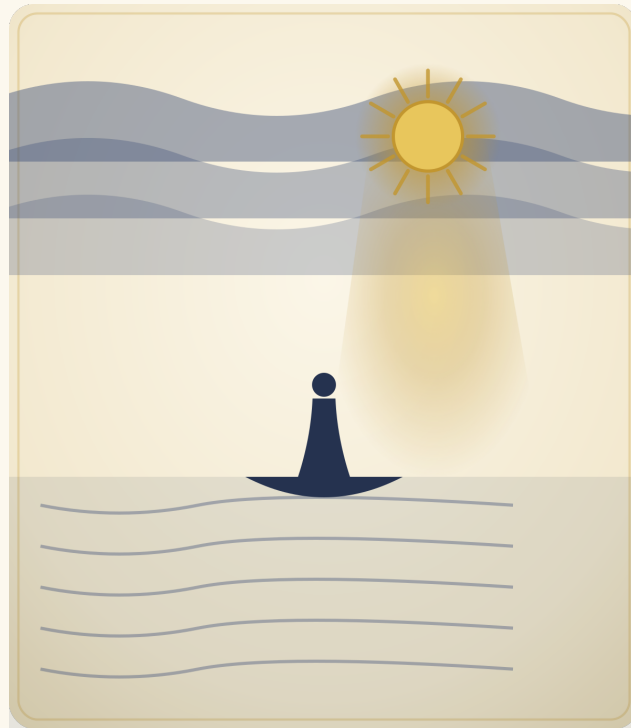
A robed figure lifts a slender wand, and from its tip a broad ribbon of gold light sweeps across the whole scene. On the left, under a grey cloud, a stalk droops and withers; on the right, the same light has opened a rose into bloom. That sweep of gold is the book's founding idea made visible: the spoken word passing over a condition and transmuting it, so that in the place of sorrow appears joy, and the wilderness blossoms as the rose. This is the whole method in one picture, and it matters because it moves the lever from your circumstances to your own tongue. Notice, in your own week, the two ways you can talk about the same situation — the withering way and the blooming way — and understand that choosing between them is not wishful thinking but the practice itself. To apply it, pick the outcome you actually want and say that, out loud, over the thing in front of you. The one thing to remember: your word is the wand — wave it over the trouble, don't just describe the trouble.

The Magic Purse



An open purse sits lit from within, its clasp a bead of gold, and coins of light rise out of it and float upward like sparks. Shinn calls this the magic purse of the spirit, and the point of the picture is that the purse is not merely full but overflowing and self-renewing — crammed and jammed, in her words — so that as money goes out, money comes in. The detail that carries the meaning is the light coming from inside the purse rather than from the coins: supply, in this view, is generated, not stored. It connects to the woman who came to Shinn holding just two dollars, blessed them as the magic purse, and shortly afterward received six thousand dollars. Why it matters is that it treats fear of running out as the real leak — the thing that closes the purse. In real life, notice the grip that comes when you spend, and practice letting money go without that clench. The principle to keep: picture supply as endless and immediate, and hold that picture especially when the wallet looks thin.

Lifting the Fog



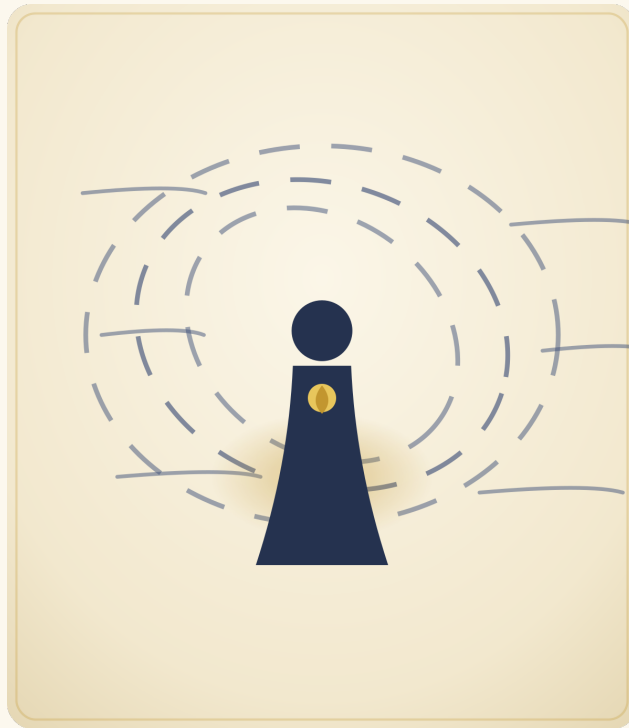
Heavy banks of grey fog hang across the top of the scene, and a single shaft of gold breaks through to a small boat where a robed figure stands on a calm sea. This is the woman at sea who woke to foghorns and a dense fog with no sign of clearing, and who declared that there are no fogs in divine mind, and gave thanks for the sun — after which, in her account, the sun came out. The meaningful contrast is between the fog above and the stillness of the water below: the conditions are heavy, but the figure is not agitated. The idea it captures is dominion — the claim that a settled person has some authority over the elements of a life, whether the fog is one of money, love, health, or happiness. It matters because the instinct in a fog is to strain and peer; the instruction here is the opposite. What to notice: the moments you can't see the way forward. To apply it, give thanks for the clearing before you can see it. The one thing to remember: you don't fight the fog, you let it be lifted.

The Door That Is Nailed Back



Through a tall archway, light pours into the room, and the door itself stands swung wide against the wall, held there by a single golden nail. A small figure steps through the opening. This is the affirmation Shinn gave a man seeking his right work: behold, the open door of destiny, and no man shall shut it, for it is nailed back. The nail is the detail that matters — not just an open door, but one that cannot swing closed again. The man, she says, was electrified by that phrase and within weeks was called to a wonderful position in a distant city. The idea is certainty: the difference between hoping a door stays open and knowing it has been fixed open. It matters because so much anxiety is the fear that the opening will close before you reach it. Notice where you're creeping toward an opportunity as if it might vanish. To apply it, speak of the door as already nailed back, and walk toward it. The principle to keep: what is truly yours cannot be shut against you.

The Unmoved Center



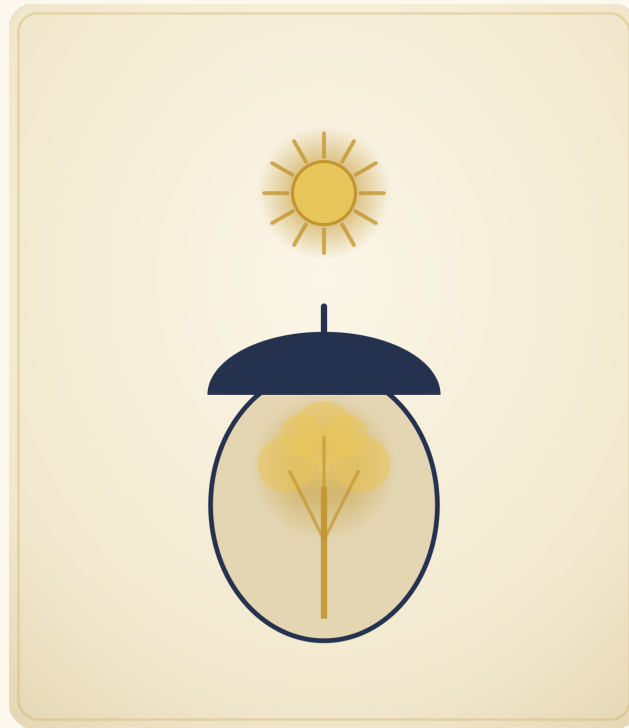
Rings of storm circle a standing figure — wind streaks, dark swirling bands — but at the center the figure is calm, planted, lit by a steady gold glow, with a small flame burning quietly at the heart. This is Shinn's line, power moves but is never moved. The composition puts everything turbulent on the outside and everything steady on the inside, which is exactly her claim: mastery is standing serene, good-humored and content precisely when appearances are against you. The small steady flame is the detail to notice — the state is not blankness, it's a quiet, undisturbed fire. It matters because she says fear and impatience demagnetize while poise magnetizes; the calm is not just pleasant, it's what makes the word work. Watch for the moment your emotions start spinning with the conditions around you. To apply it, settle yourself first — let the charge drop — and only then speak. The one thing to remember: get to the unmoved center before you say a word.

Digging the Ditches



Under a nearly clear sky, with only one small cloud on the horizon, a figure digs channels into dry, cracked ground. The ditches are empty; there is no rain yet. This is Shinn's image of active faith — dig your ditches deep with faith and understanding — the idea that faith is shown by preparing for the thing before any evidence of it arrives. The dryness is the important detail: the work is done in the absence of proof, which is what makes it faith rather than reaction. It connects to the woman who couldn't rent her room until she bought a lamp for it, and to the one who sold her furniture by polishing it in the middle of a blizzard. It matters because passive waiting never convinces the subconscious of anything; the shovel does. In your own life, notice what you're waiting to receive before you'll prepare for it, and reverse the order. To apply it, take one concrete step that only makes sense if the answer is already coming. The principle: prepare for it before you can see it.

The Acorn and the Oak



A single acorn sits at the center, and glowing inside it, in gold, is the form of a great oak — canopy and branches already present within the seed. This is Shinn's picture of what she calls the divine design: the perfect picture of the oak is in the acorn, and in the same way the pattern of your life is already complete within you, waiting to be released. The detail that carries the meaning is that the oak is not added from outside — it is lit from within the acorn itself. The idea is that you are not building a self from scratch; you are unfolding one that already exists in blueprint. It matters because it changes the task from inventing your life to listening for it. What to notice: the pull toward a direction that feels less like ambition and more like recognition. To apply it, trust the design enough to follow its small leads rather than forcing a shape it was never meant to take. The one thing to remember: the oak is already in the acorn.

The Lion on the Path



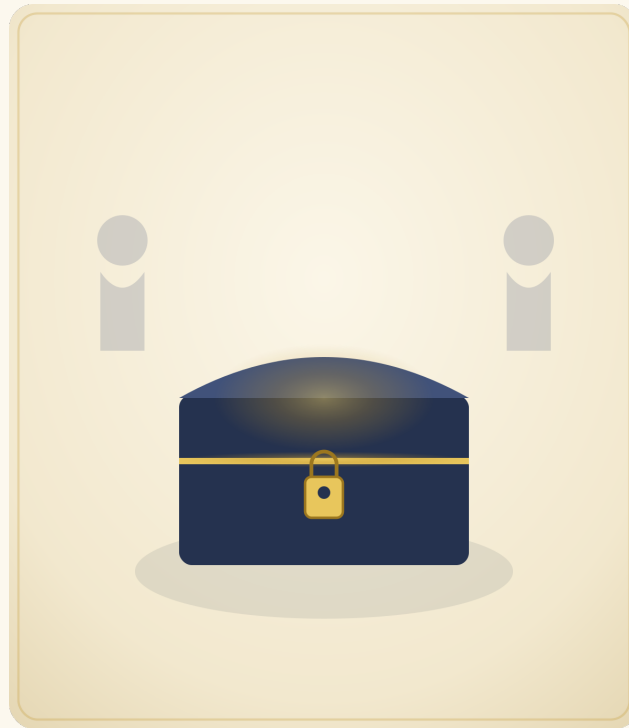
A figure walks along a path toward a lion — but the lion sits inside a halo of light, with golden wings rising from its shoulders and a ring of gold above its head. The obstacle, on approach, turns out to be an angel. This is Shinn's line, I walk up to the lion on my pathway and find an angel in armor, and the picture's whole argument is in the direction of movement: the figure walks toward the thing it fears, rather than away. The wings and halo growing out of the lion are the detail — the obstacle is not defeated, it is revealed to be an ally. It connects to the jealous woman and the reappearing cousins: the moment she blessed them instead of resisting, they stopped troubling her. It matters because our instinct is to resist what blocks us, and resistance, in this system, feeds it. Notice the obstacle you keep bracing against. To apply it, walk toward it and bless it. The principle: make friends with the hindrance, and it becomes a stepping-stone.

What Fear Steps Over



On a pavement, a small scrap that is half curled leaf and half unfurled banknote lies open in a pool of gold light, while faint footprints show where others have walked past it, and a single foot approaches. This is the woman who was walking along declaring that God was her immediate supply, looked down, and found a two-dollar bill at her feet — while a watchman told her that many people had walked over it thinking it was a scrap of gum paper, but when she came, it opened up like a leaf. The detail is the footprints: the same supply lay there for everyone, but only faith saw it. The idea is that opportunity is often lying in plain sight, and it is the quality of your seeing that reveals it. It matters because it reframes scarcity as a kind of blindness. In real life, notice how a worried mind walks straight past the very thing it needs. To apply it, look at the ground in front of you as though your supply is already there. The one thing to remember: faith sees what fear steps over.

The Faith Chest



A single chest sits closed and locked at the center, glowing softly along its seams as though it holds light, while two faint figures in the background turn their faces away. This is Shinn's distinction between a hope chest and a faith chest: a demonstration, she says, should be kept from the public eye until it comes to pass, because friends who lean on it and doubt can undo it. The light escaping the seams is the detail — something real and alive is inside, but it is protected, not displayed. The idea is that a young intention is fragile, and exposing it to other people's doubt weakens it. It matters because the impulse when we hope for something is to announce it, and the announcement invites the very skepticism that deflates us. What to notice: the urge to tell everyone about a plan that hasn't happened yet. To apply it, hold the thing quietly and let it gel before you speak of it. The principle: keep the demonstration private until it lands.

What You Dwell On Returns



A figure stands on the left, and a small dark shape leaves its mouth, loops out along a golden arc, and curves back toward it — while off to the side, that same shape has multiplied into three. This is Shinn's warning about the tongue: the thing you dwell on and speak of returns to you, because your repeated words are instructions the subconscious keeps carrying out. The loop is the detail — what you send out in speech comes back into your life. It connects to the woman who went about saying I know what trouble is, waiting for sympathy, and, in Shinn's telling, kept getting more trouble; by her own words she was condemned. It matters because we rarely notice how much we rehearse our complaints, and each rehearsal, in this view, is a re-order. What to notice: the story about your life you tell most often. To apply it, stop describing what you don't want, and speak the release instead. The one thing to remember: don't multiply the thing by talking about it.

Giving Opens the Channel



A figure tips a pitcher, and a stream of gold pours out and branches into several small channels — and then, in a wide glowing arc, a far larger stream curves back toward the figure. This is Shinn's law that giving precedes receiving: you open the channels of supply by giving, and clutching closes them. The two directions of flow are the detail — the small streams going out, the broad stream returning — and the return is larger than the gift. It connects to the woman who needed five hundred dollars, was told the trouble was that she didn't give enough, and finally received exactly five hundred dollars from her hostess after she began making small gifts and tipping generously. It matters because when supply feels stuck, the instinct is to hold tighter, which is the opposite of the instruction. Notice the clench that comes when you feel short. To apply it, give something freely — money, time, goodwill — while you wait. The principle: open the channel by giving first.

The Needle True to North



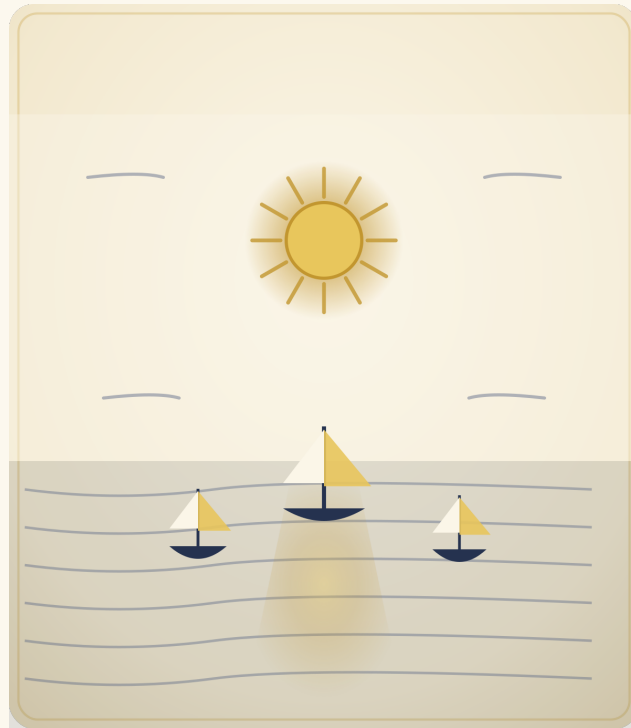
A compass fills the center, and its needle glows gold, swinging firmly to the north, while a small figure sets out below along the direction it points. This is Shinn's image for intuition and the divine design: as the needle in the compass is true to the north, what is rightfully yours is true to you. The steadiness of the needle is the detail — it doesn't wander, it settles on one direction. She calls intuitive leads hunches, and says they are the hounds of heaven that lead you in the perfect way. The idea is that guidance is available and reliable if you will follow it rather than argue with it. It matters because most people override their leads with reasoning and then wonder why the way feels forced. What to notice: the quiet, persistent nudge that keeps pointing the same way. To apply it, act on the hunch promptly, while it's fresh. The one thing to remember: never argue with a hunch.

Built Upon a Rock



A single figure stands on a solid rock, lit by a steady gold light above, while small waves break against the base of the stone without moving it. This is Shinn's repeated phrase, built upon a rock — my faith is built upon a rock, my happiness is built upon a rock. The contrast between the battering water and the unmoved stone is the whole point: the appearances press against the foundation, and the foundation holds. The idea is that poise is not the absence of trouble but a stability that trouble cannot shift. It matters because a faith that only survives good weather isn't much of a foundation; the claim here is for one that stands while the waves come. What to notice: the difference between being shaken by bad news and standing steady through it. To apply it, root your confidence in the principle rather than in the day's evidence. The principle: build on the rock, and let the waves come.

Ships Over a Calm Sea



Ships come in toward shore over a still, gold-lit sea, their sails full, while faint marks of wind press inward from all four corners of the scene. This is Shinn's picture of supply arriving: my ships come in over a calm sea, and the four winds of success now blow to me my own — from north, south, east and west comes my endless good. The calm water is the important detail: the ships are not fought for through a storm; they arrive on a settled sea. The four winds are the second detail — good is pictured as coming from every direction at once, not through one narrow channel you have to force. It matters because it counters the belief that your supply depends on a single source that might fail. Notice how often worry fixates on one door closing. To apply it, expect your good from any direction, and keep the sea calm by staying unafraid. The one thing to remember: your ships come in over a calm sea.

Waving It Over the Wall



A figure raises a wand, gold light sweeps across, and a wall on the left breaks apart — its blocks turning to light as they scatter — while on the right a bright road opens into the distance. This is the book's closing gathered into one image: choose the affirmation that appeals to you and wave it over the situation that confronts you, and watch the wall of limitation come down, the way Shinn says the walls of Jericho fell and lack and failure were wiped from consciousness. The blocks becoming light are the detail — the obstacle isn't smashed so much as dissolved back into possibility. The open road is the second detail: what was blocked becomes a way through. It matters because it is the practice in a single move, the thing you can actually do in any moment. What to notice: the wall you've been treating as permanent. To apply it, pick one word and wave it, and hold to the closing promise — nothing is too good to be true, nothing is too wonderful to happen, nothing is too good to last. The one thing to remember: the word brings the wall down and opens the road.

The Sequence as a Whole

Seen in sequence, the sixteen images trace one motion. The wand opens the collection and closes it, because the whole book is that single gesture — a word waved over a condition. Between them, the plates show what the gesture requires and what it does: the vivid picture and the fearless, unmoved state a word is spoken from; the ditches dug and the channel opened by giving; the obstacle blessed until the lion becomes an angel and the wall becomes a road; the supply that was always there, unfurling like a leaf at the feet of anyone with the eyes to see it. Let each image be a hook. When you meet a fog, a closed-looking door, a lion on the path, let the picture surface first — and then speak the word that goes with it.